

1.2.1 Figuring Out Configuring

When installing a new device or program on your computer, you may sometimes need to configure it. In this case, after your ISP connects the requisite hardware (modem, cable, etc.), you'll have to set the basic parameters that will allow your system to smoothly interact with the ISP to give you a hassle-free access to Net. These days, thanks to new technologies, it's usually just plug-and-play. Yet, for all you guys who don't want to bother the ISP service men too much, here's how you could do it.

If you're working on a network, prior to setting up any connections at all, you'll need to tell your computer the IP address you've been allotted. If the ISP has given you a permanent one (for a detailed explanation of what an IP address is, take a peek at Chapter 2). Your network administrator would be the right guy to ask for the IP address already allotted to your particular network. If, however, your ISP provides you with a fresh IP address each time you log in—and this is how most private broadband connections prefer it—you'll have to keep the settings to automatic. Here's how:

Step 1: Right click on My Network Places on the Desktop and click on Properties. This opens the Network Connections Window.

Step 2: Right click on the LAN icon and again choose Properties. This takes you to the Local Area Network Properties window, which gives you details regarding which modem you're using, and what items the connection uses.

Step 3: Double-click on the line that says Internet Protocol (TCP/IP). If your ISP provides you with specific IP addresses and DNS addresses, fill them in the exact same way as they gave it to you. This will enable your ISP's computer to identify you as a particular user every time you access the service.

Step 4: With most broadband connections today, simply choose the option that says Obtain an IP address automatically. This is also the default setting in windows.

In case your computer is part of more than one network, you'll have to give alternative configurations too. This can be done by clicking on Alternative Configuration.